

ACTIVITY 16 — FACILITATOR GUIDE**KPI Dashboard Design**

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Case Study	20 minutes	LU4	LU4 — Branding Effectiveness

Purpose of this activity

By the end of this activity learners will be able to monitor the success of the brand against Key Performance Indicators (KPI) (LU4).

What learners produce

A SMART KPI framework — 3 internal + 3 external KPIs, each with an owner, target, data source, review deadline and a missed-target trigger.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- Flipchart or A3 sheet and markers
- The course slides for the scenario and framework
- Internet access where the activity calls for live research

Set-up

Groups of 3–5. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group. All 17 activities run on the same continuous Nimbus Wellness scenario, so remind learners of where this activity sits in that story before you start.

Scenario / briefing material

The Board's ask is specific: it wants a KPI framework it can check every month after the relaunch, not a one-off report from Marketing whenever someone remembers to send it. The founder, who is not a numbers person, has asked for something she can read in five minutes and still trust.

Right now every department tracks something different — Marketing watches follower counts, Retail watches footfall, Customer Service watches response times — and none of it is compared against a target or a deadline. Last month someone reported "engagement is up" without saying up from what, or by when it should keep rising.

Your table's job is to turn this scattered activity into a small set of SMART KPIs the Board can actually govern the relaunch by.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
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1	Audit the current state. List what each department tracks today: Marketing on followers, Retail on footfall, Customer Service on response times. Mark that none has a target or a deadline — that is precisely why 'engagement is up' was meaningless.	Follower count is the classic KPI that fails Relevant — use it to teach the decision-value test.
2	Distinguish internal from external KPIs. Internal KPIs measure what Nimbus does (response time, publishing cadence, staff training completion). External KPIs measure how the market responds (sentiment, repeat purchase, share of voice). A framework of only internal KPIs measures activity, not results.	Departments as owners ('Marketing') let accountability evaporate; insist on a person.
3	Select three of each. Choose for decision value, not for ease of extraction. The test: if this number moved, would the Board actually do something differently? If not, cut it.	
4	Run one KPI through the full SMART test. Take your weakest KPI and test it: Specific (exactly what is counted?), Measurable (from which system?), Achievable (given the team and budget?), Relevant (to the relaunch objective?), Time-bound (by when?). Note where it first breaks — usually Specific or Time-bound — and fix it.	
5	Repair the rest. Apply the same test quickly to the remaining five and tighten each.	
6	Assign the four fields. Every KPI needs a named owner (a person, not a department), a numeric target, a data source, and a review deadline. A KPI without an owner is nobody's job.	
7	Define the escalation. Write what happens if a KPI misses target two months running — who is told, what gets reviewed, what decision is triggered. Without this the dashboard is reporting, not governance.	
8	Design the five-minute view. The founder is not a numbers person. Choose the smallest set of numbers that still tells the whole story on one slide, and lay it out. Usually one headline number per pillar with a trend arrow.	

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
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3 min	Audit what each department currently tracks
6 min	Select 3 internal and 3 external KPIs
6 min	Run one KPI through the full SMART test
3 min	Assign owner, target, source and review date
2 min	Define the missed-target escalation

Total: 20 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. Which 3 internal and 3 external KPIs would actually tell the Board whether the relaunch is working — not just which numbers are easiest for each department to pull?
2. Take one of your KPIs through the full SMART test — where does it break down first, and how do you fix that?
3. Who owns each KPI, and what happens if the number misses target two months in a row?
4. If the Board can only look at one dashboard slide, what's the smallest set of numbers that still tells the whole story?

Debrief

Bring the class back together and draw out the learning:

- Ask two or three groups to show what they produced, not just what they concluded.
- Ask what surprised them — the gap between what they assumed and what they found.
- Link the activity explicitly back to LU4 — Branding Effectiveness.
- Remind learners this activity rehearses what the Case Study assessment will require.

Reflection questions:

- Which of your KPIs was hardest to make genuinely Measurable rather than just a description of activity?
- Did your table set a target that was Attainable, or did ambition win out over realism?
- If one KPI is red for two straight months, does your framework actually say what happens next — or does it stop at reporting the number?

Facilitator notes — what to watch for

- Follower count is the classic KPI that fails Relevant — use it to teach the decision-value test.
- Departments as owners ('Marketing') let accountability evaporate; insist on a person.

Success criterion

Every group can show 3 internal + 3 external KPIs, each SMART-tested with a named owner, target, data source and review deadline, and can explain what action a missed target would trigger.

Assessment link

This activity builds LU4 — Branding Effectiveness. All 17 activities are in-class activities assessed indirectly through the open-book Case Study (CS) component, which reuses the same techniques on the same continuous Nimbus Wellness scenario. Knowledge is assessed in the Written Assessment (WA-SAQ). Nothing is assessed that is not practised here or taught in the slides.